

Slides 3.7: Stress: What It Is, and My Stress Map

Slide outline for Lesson 3.7. Eleven slides. Slide 10 carries the who-to-ask list; I fill in the counselor's name, the nurse's room, and the help line the school approves before this runs. The map is private; slide 6 says so and I say so twice.

Slide 1: Stress: What It Is, and My Stress Map

- Lesson 3.7: Self-Concept, Peers, and Stress
- Unit 3: Growing Up, Getting Along
- Do now, private: rate how stressed you feel right now, 1 (calm) to 5 (a lot). One word for why. Nobody collects this Notes: Hands if 4 or 5. Hands if 1 or 2. Both go up. That is the point.

Slide 2: The smoke alarm

- It goes off when there is smoke
- It also goes off when you make toast
- It is doing its job both times
- So is your stress. Today: tell the toast from the fire Image: a round ceiling smoke alarm, drawn plainly, with a small piece of toast under it.

Slide 3: What stress is

- The body's response to a demand or a threat
- Heart speeds up, muscles tighten, mind focuses or races
- It is not a flaw. It is an alarm
- The adolescent brain (Lesson 3.3) feels it strongly. Short sleep (Lesson 2.6) makes it louder Notes: Students copy the definition onto Part 1.

Slide 4: Good stress, bad stress

- Good: short, pointed at something you can do (a game, a test you studied for, a performance). Sharpens you, then leaves
- Bad: too big, too long, or pointed at something you cannot control. Wears you down. Does not leave on its own
- Same alarm, different fire Notes: One example of each on Part 1. Whiteboard check: "Nervous before a game you practiced for all week: good or bad?" Good.

Slide 5: Body signals

- Headache. Stomach ache. Tight shoulders. Fast heart. Sweaty hands
- Trouble sleeping. Not hungry, or very hungry. Cannot focus. Tired all the time
- Snapping at people. Going quiet
- Mark where yours shows up first. The first signal is the early warning Image: a plain body outline, no features, with the signals labeled around it. Notes: Build the list from the room before showing it. Students mark Part 2.

Slide 6: Your stress map

- Two grids: when (time of day by day of week) and where (home, school, bus, phone, practice, other)
 - Shade the boxes where stress shows up most. Light for a little, dark for a lot
 - Then list your stressors (the things that cause your stress) in the table under the grids, a few words each
 - This page is yours. It stays in your folder. Nobody reads it unless you want them to
- Notes: Say the privacy line now. Say it again at the exit strip.

Slide 7: Five categories

- S: school (a book). A test, a project, a grade
- F: friends (two people). A group chat argument, being left out
- H: home and family (a house). A sibling, a rule, a worry at home
- P: phones and online (a phone). A post that got no likes, a chat that will not stop
- M: money (a coin). A thing everyone else can buy
- Tag each stressor with a letter. Star the biggest one Notes: These are general examples. Do not ask anyone which one is theirs.

Slide 8: Patterns

- Sunday night shows up on a lot of maps
- So does the bus
- Grade 8 stretch: find a pattern (the same time every week, or the same place). What could change the pattern, not the feeling? Notes: Name Sunday night out loud without asking anyone to own it.

Slide 9: Handle it, or bring it

- Handle it yourself with a tool (tomorrow): a test, a game, a busy week, an argument that will blow over, a Sunday night
- Bring it to an adult: anything that lasts for weeks; anything about safety; anything that makes you not want to be here; a friend who says any of those; anything you are not sure about
- Not sure which pile? That is a “bring it” Notes: Students sort their starred stressor on Part 4.

Slide 10: Who to ask

- The school counselor, in the counseling office
- The nurse, in the nurse’s office
- Any teacher, including me
- The main office
- An adult at home
- A help line the school approves Notes: Students copy this onto the back of the map for keeps. This is the one thing nobody leaves without.

Slide 11: Exit strip and tomorrow

- Tear off the strip. Turn it in
- 3 body signals. 2 categories most common for people your age. 1 adult (a role) you would bring the big kind to
- Tomorrow: six tools, tested in this room, on your own number. Keep the ones that work Notes: The two categories named most become the example stressors on the Lesson 3.9 Stress Plan slide.